

DIAGNOSTIC TESTING

This test will help to determine a client's susceptibility to both base-rate bias and sample-size neglect bias.

Base-Rate Neglect Representativeness Bias Test

- Question 1:** Jim is an ex-college baseball player. After he graduated from college, Jim became a physical education teacher. Jim has two sons, both of whom are excellent athletes. Which is more likely?
- a. Jim coaches a local Little League team.
 - b. Jim coaches a local Little League team and plays softball with the local softball team.

Sample-Size Neglect Representativeness Bias Test

- Question 2:** Consider the two sequences of coin-toss results shown (Figure 7.3). Assume that an unbiased coin has been used. Which of the sequences pictured do you think is more likely: A or B?

Test Results Analysis

- Question 1:** Respondents who chose “b,” which is the predictable answer, are likely to suffer from base-rate neglect representativeness bias. It is *possible* that Jim both coaches and plays softball, but it is *more likely* that he only coaches Little League. Figure 7.4 illustrates this.

- Question 2:** Most people ascertain Sequence A to be more likely, simply because it appears more “random.” In fact, both sequences are



FIGURE 7.3 Sample-Size Neglect Diagnostic: Which Sequence of Coin Toss Results Appears Likelier?